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Government of Nepal
Home Ministry
National Disaster Risk Reduction and
Management Authority



WEBINAR

An Interaction Meeting on NRA Disengagement Plan and NDRRMA Engagement Plan

10th May 2021

An Interaction meeting on NRA Disengagement Plan & NDRRMA Engagement Plan

The National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) is scheduled to phase out at the end of 2021 and therefore sustainability of reconstruction efforts is paramount to NRA and the government agencies. In this regard, the NRA is transitioning its responsibilities to other government agencies and primarily to the National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Authority (NDRRMA) as a successor of NRA. Accordingly, NRA's disengagement plan has been prepared for successful transition to NDRRMA and other government agencies including local governments. NDRRMA is also collaborating with NRA and leading its efforts to build disaster resilient communities.

This sharing session aims at understanding what the NRA disengagement plan is and how it is transitioning its work to NDRRMA including other government agencies and local governments. It is in this connection, all development partners, governments including partner organizations who supported Nepal's recovery and reconstruction efforts need to understand the overall disengagement plan of NRA and engagement plan of NDRRMA so that partners can accordingly align their development activities to have synergic effect on the works of local governments and other government agencies.

May 10 2021
START 2 PM NST

Join from ZOOM at
Webinar ID: 928 1017 4503
Passcode: 808089

Agenda:

02:00-02:05	Welcome and introduction of the event (5 min)
02:05-02:25	Presentation by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha (20 min)
02:25-02:45	Presentation by Mr. Anil Pokharel (20 min)
02:45-03:25	Q & A on the presentations (40 min)
03:25-03:30	Closing (5 min)

Our Speakers

Dr. Chandra B. Shrestha
Executive Committee Member
National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)

Mr. Anil Pokharel
Executive Director
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA)

Facilitated by:

HRRP is funded by CRS and DFID

PANELISTS

- Dr. **Chandra Bahadur Shrestha**; Executive Member, NRA
- Mr. **Anil Pokharel**; Executive Director, NDRRMA

*Link to complete webinar recording [here](#).

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

CLPIU	Central Level Project Implementation Unit
COVID-19	CoronaVirus Disease
CRS	Catholic Relief Services
DLPIU	District Level Project Implementation Unit
GMaLI	Grant Management and Local Infrastructure
DoLI	Department of Local Infrastructures
DoA	Department of Archeology
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
DUDBC	Department of Urban Development and Building Construction
GoN	Government of Nepal
HRRP	Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform
JICA	Japan International Cooperation Agency
MDTF	Multi Donor Trust Fund
MoHA	Ministry of Home Affairs
MoFAGA	Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration
MoUD	Ministry of Urban Development
NDRRMA	National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority
NRA	National Reconstruction Authority
WB	World Bank

1. BACKGROUND

1.1 Introduction

The National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) was officially established on 25 December 2015^[1], with the main objective of rapid reconstruction of the physical damages caused by the massive earthquakes of April 25 and May 12, 2015 and their aftershocks.

Since its establishment, the NRA, has very effectively spearheaded the tremendous interventions in post-earthquake reconstruction and recovery in various sectors including private housing, school buildings, heritage monuments, government buildings and several other public infrastructures in order to facilitate the affected beneficiaries at large. After six years of work, NRA is scheduled to phase out at the end of December 2021 and therefore sustainability of reconstruction efforts is paramount to NRA and the government agencies. In this regard, the NRA is transitioning its responsibilities to other government agencies and primarily to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) as the successor of NRA.

Accordingly, a multi-sectoral/government team led by NRA prepared the “**Disengagement Plan of NRA- 2021**”^[2] a few months back for successful and effective transition to NDRRMA and other government agencies including local governments. NDRRMA, as an apex operational body established as per the DRRM Act 2017 by Government of Nepal (GoN), to work on disaster risk reduction (DRR) and management, has been striving to build disaster resilient communities in close coordination and collaboration with NRA, government agencies, development partners including I/NGOs partner organizations who supported Nepal’s recovery and reconstruction efforts.

Thus, in order to better understand the NRA disengagement plan coined up with NDRRMA engagement plan for the sustainability of Nepal’s post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction efforts, this interaction meeting was organized, where Dr. **Chandra B. Shrestha**, Executive Committee Member of NRA and Mr. **Anil Pokharel**, Executive Director of NDRRMA, briefed participants on the transition process and responded to questions asked by participants of the interactive meeting.

1.2 Objectives of the Interaction Meeting

The virtual interaction meeting aimed at following objectives inclusively:

[1] <http://www.nra.gov.np/en/pages/view/fk2lRwucsHVwn91-LAXpTW9mGJglRz25rUWNDHdbkYk>

[2] 2077 Falgun.

1. To understand about the NRA's disengagement plan and clarify on who are the likely government agencies to take over the responsibilities further.
2. To understand how the exit strategy of NRA is transitioning towards NDRRMA including other government agencies and local governments.
3. To share the roadmap of the successful transitioning of NRA primarily towards NDRRMA.
4. To discuss on how NDRRMA is engaging with NRA as successor and how to achieve the handover responsibilities and understand on how partners can contribute in the transition phase and beyond.

2. INTERACTION MEETING

2.1 Welcome and Opening Session

The meeting was organised virtually through online Zoom, considering COVID-19 safety protocols and ongoing prohibitory order to avoid large gatherings or holding of events, issued by Kathmandu District Administration Office (DAO)/GoN.

Mr. **Ruplal Aidi**, Team Lead of General Coordination - HRRP, facilitated the entire interaction meeting highlighting on the overall objective of the interactive meeting while Mr. Minar Thapa Magar, National Coordinator - HRRP facilitated the questions and answers session. Mr. Aidi welcomed all the participants (over 200 in attendance) and introduced the two keynote speakers namely Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, NRA Executive Committee Member and Mr. Anil Pokharel, Executive Director, NDRRMA.

2.2 Presentation on NRA's Exit Strategy



Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha

Executive Committee Member, NRA

Key Highlights of Presentation by Dr. C.B. Shrestha

Dr. C.B. Shrestha presented on the NRA's Exit strategy by highlighting all the collective tremendous efforts and initiatives that have been put in over the past 6 years by NRA towards rebuilding Nepal of post- earthquake. He noted that as per the exit strategy, NRA has now come to its smooth conclusion phase and is going to be phased out soon in two steps; by July 2021, NRA will end all its regular operations; and secondly, the final remaining 6 months period (July- December 2021) will be utilized on systematic handing over process to relevant possible successor GoN agencies (Ministries and Departments) and local governments . Major infrastructure reconstruction and recovery along with its handover has been done to concerned agencies and local governments by NRA and through its district based counterparts too.

The presentation focused on six key aspects, including current status of reconstruction, exit plan and finally the potential challenges for potential successor GoN agencies.

On the current status of reconstruction, Dr. Chandra noted that 92% of 811,745 beneficiaries of private houses have completed their structural reconstruction. Also, 90% of 4,720 vulnerable households have resettled back to resilient houses while 12,284 landless households have been

provided safe shelters through relocation addressal.

Further, over 80% of the total 7,553 school buildings have been nearly completed. Likewise, 70 % of the 1,197 health buildings have been reconstructed; Further, 49% heritage monuments out of 920 have been conserved. Any other remaining reconstruction of infrastructure tasks that were not achievable in NRA's current timeline, will be handed over to respective government institutions.

Further, all road projects will be completed by July this year and 764 KM of strategic and local roads are completed. Also, 791 Water and Sanitation schemes are on verge of completion in the mentioned timeline. Remaining reconstruction processes will be taken over by the successor institutions, he noted. So overall message, he reiterated is that the NRA has almost concluded its role.

On the Exit strategy, Dr. Chandra said that as a part of bigger principles of NRA's Exit Strategy, local governments have been seen as de facto institutions for local level community works and NRA is engaging with NDRRMA as NRA's successor, further in the transition process while aligning with concerned GoN Ministries and Departments. Few tasks, such as rolling over of National Building Code -105 at all local levels is the next level of engagement while institutionalization of reconstruction and recovery work through promotion of museum establishment and initiations for international-Level "Earthquake Research Center" at the Tribhuvan University /Institute of Engineering (IoE) Pulchowk as well as establishing an Earthquake memorial.

On the principles of NRA Exit Strategy, Dr. Chandra added that, further to the NRA's Exit Plan (Refer Annex 1), NRA has documented all NRA lessons learned by incorporating majority of its learnings and reflections and it will be reflected through upcoming publication of 18 key scientific as well as institutional documents. Similarly, as decided by the recent meeting of the NRA Steering Committee, an International Conference of Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR) is in the pipeline to be conducted during last week of November/ First week December 2021, where all the documentation and dissemination of NRA learnings will be done through the ICNR on learnings and achievements of Nepal's post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction, said Dr. Chandra.

On the first part of the Exit plan (See powerpoint slides, Annex 1-NRA Exit Plan-1), Dr. Chandra said that NDRRMA as the successor of NRA may not have serious implementation

responsibility, however NRA has made constructive Exit Plan, according to the thematic task (see slides) so that de facto governing body (NDRRMA) will receive support and assistance from all concerning GoN agencies.

Further, as per the presentation, for the thematic remaining works on 'private housing, integrated settlement, and settlement relocation'- the proposal is for Central Level Project Implementation Units (CLPIU)- Building and CLPIU-GMaLI to be merged as CLPIU (Building and Housing) to operate under MoUD.

Similarly for district-level, the proposal is for District Level Project Implementation Unit (DLPIU-Building) and DLPIU-GMaLI to be merged as DLPIU (Building and Housing) that will operate under CLPIU. Further, NDRMMA will control, monitor and direct CLPIU's operations, noted Dr. Shrestha.

Furthermore, for several other thematic tasks, GoN line Ministries, line agencies and relevant departments such as Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC), Department of Local Infrastructures (DoLI), Department of Archaeology (DoA) is to take over. In the process of transferring of responsibilities, capacity enhancement and ensuring accountability measures will also be instilled with the successor agency.

As a part of the NRA's Exit Plan, ensuring sustainability of resilient housing efforts through the maintenance regime has to be taken on further to secure robust infrastructures while retrofitting of buildings remains as prime focus of this regime too. NRA's Exit Plan will highlight these types of paradigm shifts and continuously steer it towards its implementation. NRA will steer the Ministry of Urban Development (MOUD) to engage constructively with local governments so that the compliance of building codes are assured at local levels conductively, noted Dr. C.B.Shrestha.

On the possible challenges ahead for the successor agencies after handover, with cautious optimism, Dr. Shrestha noted that , NRA is quite optimistic about the technical capacity of DoLI to take forward development of public infrastructures in connection with reconstruction. NRA will further work towards strengthening institutional capacity of DoA so that recovery of heritage monuments are assured in the process. Last but not the least, proper ground works to attain adequate mainstreaming of livelihood initiatives through the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MOFAGA)'s engagement will be ensured by NRA as good nursing is believed to add value to prosperous livelihoods of earthquake affected people, said Dr. Shrestha.

In concluding his presentation, Dr. C.B. Shrestha said that post- 2015 Earthquake reconstruction was largely done through tremendous efforts from every possible actor, however NRA believes that the successor will take a role of putting ‘cherry on the cake’ (symbolically). Key takeaways from these discussions revolve around generating affirmative actions, meaningful engagements and collective efforts from all development partners, federal, provincial and local governments at large to make a capacitated and disaster resilient nation.



Mr. Anil Pokharel

Executive Director, NDRRMA

Key Highlights of Presentation by Mr. Pokharel

In his opening remarks, Executive Director Pokharel thanked the organizers and said ‘we did not call this process a handover or a takeover process from the beginning, the reason being this as a historical opportunity to learn from 2015 earthquake reconstruction and recovery process that has been garnered in Nepal under the leadership of NRA. This is indeed a historical moment’, he said.

He then went on to note that the real challenges now is how we institutionalize the learnings within NDRRMA and bring change in the way we do disaster risk reduction and management. NDRRMA from past 16 months in close proximity with NRA has looked deeply into other different disasters, multi-hazards and its possible recovery processes and the challenge is that, NDRRMA has to learn and prepare for in the nearly 9 months (till-December 2021).

Mr. Pokharel shared that, in order to address everybody’s concern on challenges of taking over NRA’s role, three pronged pillars have been sketched by NDRRMA. These include:

- i. Risk Assessment,
- ii. Governance,
- iii. Reconstruction and Recovery.

These three pillars and questions are being discussed at the highest level of government as well as the recent National Council meeting, chaired by Rt. Honorable Prime Minister as well as in the Executive Committee and ministerial level high level meetings, he said.

A task force has been created for this purpose to make a grand design on the national campaign

of making Nepal, a disaster resilient country by 2030, he said.

Mr. Pokharel shared that the four-members of the task force includes,

- i. Chief Secretary of GoN
- ii. CEO of NRA
- iii. Executive Director of NDRRMA and
- iv. Secretary of MoHA

and the team will look explicitly into four particular aspects:

- i. To look at current governance mechanisms that explores the laws/Acts that governs NDRRMA and NRA.
- ii. To look at financing mechanisms on how NRA and NDRRMA receives government finances/fiscal budget for risk reductions and management.
- iii. To learn from NRA's organisational structures and to look into limitations of the present structure of NDRRMA.
- iv. To learn from information generated by NRA including official Guidelines and Directives prepared that governs the whole reconstruction, risk reduction and recovery processes.

He added that the sound learnings and reflections from all the four areas will result into a formation of comprehensive guidelines that forms a basis of roadmap for NDRRMA in taking forward the responsibility handed over by NRA as well as to encompass the various kinds of disasters and hazards including of not only earthquake, but also floods, landslides, forest fire, lightening and so on, that affects communities of Nepal throughout.

Executive Director Pokharel further assured that NDRRMA will take stock of activities of NRA along with a huge volume of achievements and success stories, huge amount of data sets, documents and numerous teams by institutionalisation. The 4-member task force has collectively worked from the past 5 months to prepare an action plan on how to roll out the probable engagement frameworks that encircle earthquake to multi-hazards recovery, for which financing aspects will be largely worked out.

Meanwhile, Mr. Pokharel noted that some prominent works has been carried out in the meantime with help of NRA that includes:

- Landslides risk assessment in 14th earthquake affected districts
- The key footprints from NRA's larger reconstruction and recovery work has been overlaid into the NDRRMA's Bipad (disaster) Portal Platform (<https://www.bipad.gov.np/np/>)

- Guidelines preparation on specific topics is ongoing with highlights on the hydro-geological assessment done in Sindhupalchowk district in areas that were hugely affected by 2020 monsoon
- Training manuals on DRR targeting local governments that were affected by 2015 earthquake

He highlighted that Restructuring of NDRRMA's organizational structure is another area of engagement in the future days to come. Setting up the specialised units such as training centres, full-packed warehouses and the fire fighting divisions in all 7 provinces is our forthcoming targets. National DRR Training Center will be established at the Institute of Engineering (IoE), Pulchowk, he added.

World Bank Nepal has shown key interests in the next level of collaborations with NDRRMA, while Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) is supporting rural recovery. Similarly, assurances from other multiple donors and organizations are in the pipeline.

A Task force has been set up to look into joint priority areas including of -structural integrity, assessment of critical public infrastructures along with schools, health centres in non-earthquake affected districts, earthquake memorial museum and research centre development, preparation of designing curriculum on DRR and building codes and conducting DRR preparedness demonstration works in other non-earthquake affected municipalities. Needful support and assistance is required from all concerned and interested development partners in taking forward these massive responsibilities, shared Executive Director Pokharel.

3. QUESTION AND ANSWER (Q&A) SESSION

Mr. **Minar Thapa Magar**, National Coordinator of HRRP facilitated the questions and answers session between the presenters and participants. Some questions were received from some participants through video/audio appearance while numerous queries were consolidated from the zoom message box. Some queries were answered during the session during remarks and through back responses in the chat box too. The summary of Q & A are mentioned below:

Q: Can NDRRMA directly monitor and supervise CLPIUs and DLPIUs that are under NRA currently? Is there any framework developed for monitoring and supervision?

A: *NDRRMA will have to restructure adequately from its organisational aspects to the financial frames too in order to fully address the recovery programs and to align with concerned GoN Ministries, agencies and departments. Accountability mechanisms of NDRRMA has to be worked out to make it strong and vibrant.*

Q: Does NDRRMA have any plans/strategy for complex multi-hazards events such as monsoon floods in earthquake affected districts? Can NDRRMA intervene in any multi-hazards themes in earthquake affected districts?

A: *NDRRMA has an agenda to look into addressing the multi-hazards spheres and jointly with NRA has charted out guidelines to address such hazards in earthquake affected districts. The 2020 monsoon landslides in various districts of Nepal, including Sindhupalchowk as the most affected district, were hit hard mostly to earthquake affected households. Initial estimate shows that 11,200 plus private houses were affected in Sindhupalchowk district alone.*

World Bank Nepal partly through its fund has implemented housing reconstruction and recovery of affected households in Sindhupalchowk. NDRRMA has been able to channel the resources through respective district agencies and transferred to beneficiaries' bank accounts. Currently reconstruction of landslide-affected 47 houses in Myagdi district is ongoing. Work on identifying beneficiaries in Bhojpur and Dhankuta district has been completed. Slowly and steadily, NDRRMA is taking stock of footprints of NRA's and other agencies' interventions and consolidating past informations in order to feed into common national Bipad Portal (<https://www.bipad.gov.np/>)

Q: Considering the large amount of remaining works of NRA, there is a need for discussions at political, professional and research level that the tenure of NRA can be extended beyond 6 years too. Similar other post-disaster countries have such past experiences of extension of their reconstruction authority's original tenure. Doing so will help NDRRMA to prepare

solid grounds for formulating response strategies along with the handover.

A: *Currently NRA is not in a stand to extend its tenure and has prepared in sound manner to hand over its remaining works as an exit plan. How to capacitate the recipient institution should remain as the political and professional discussions and NRA is always ready and open to such discussions as well as to make the successor accountable on its actions.*

Q: Is NRA going to open grievances channels again for vulnerable beneficiaries, considering that a large number of vulnerables are yet to stay in reconstructed housings?

A: *Out of 18,000 identified vulnerable beneficiaries, approximately 9,000 have already reconstructed their houses through various different means and processes. Vulnerability due to land displacement has been resolved while remaining households dealing with physical ability and socio-political issues will be resolved soon. Funded by Catholic Relief Services (CRS)-Nepal, one large scale initiative on recovery of vulnerable beneficiaries will soon unfold that will look to support nearly 6,000 vulnerable beneficiaries. In the remaining timeline of NRA, rest of the case loads will be taken care of by notifying respective local governments and NGOs response will be sought too.*

Q: How NDRRMA ensures its capacity, human resources mechanisms and aspirations to conduct all activities of earthquake reconstruction and multi hazards works too after NRA's exit as well as how to hold the capacities and partnership that NRA aligned for 6 years?

A: *Current organisational setting of NDRRMA is in fact incapable to handle this huge volume of work from the NRA. At the highest political level (from Cabinet to Council of Ministers and upto senior government level), clear recognition of NDRRMA has been framed that it needs to be strengthened, extended and amendments in the current Acts, staffings and financial mechanisms.*

NDRRMA is currently under MoHA, but best efforts are laid forward to take in-country experiences from various spheres. The mentioned 4-member task force team meets on a weekly basis, to inculcate the learnings and revise the Acts that governs NDRRMA in order to prepare for multi-hazards spheres. One of the key tasks is to chart out the effective plan to revise Acts, formulate new organizational structures, clarify financial mechanisms and prepare governance guidelines.

Inheriting the trained staff of NRA will be another level of discussions. Learning from other countries in terms of how to chart out response mechanisms is something that NDRRMA has been working on and will continue to work on. As a part of following the footprints of NRA,

NDRRMA has started working with HRRP on taking a number of various data sets, to further add in the Bipad Portal. We work with CARE Nepal and also other institutions. Collective learning will chart out the effective response mechanism.

Q: Is NDRRMA as an apex body equipped enough to deal with many kinds of disaster events? Has NDRRMA made any standard of guidelines, methodologies or risk modelling systems so that any types of risk hazards can be addressed systematically? How is NDRRMA thinking to reach to provincial and upto local level to act systematically on disaster events?

A: The Executive committee of NDRRMA has decided to get the risk assessment done by multiple agencies including I/NGOs, private sectors and other development partners in clearly compiling the past risk information in case of disaster events and feed this collective information into the national disaster portal (BIPAD Portal). Currently there is a lack of risk assessment guidelines however NDRRMA is in the process of finalising ToR to draft those guidelines through World Bank and MDTF support. Three guidelines mainly on - fire outbreak, flood and lightening is underway. NDRRMA has revamped the Bipad Portal' where data import and export can be done for proper articulation and sharing and to make data available in understandable and actionable format. BIPAD Portal aims to reach to municipal level for which engagement with CARE Nepal is ongoing and also to structure the information on vulnerability in Sindhupalchowk district. Contextually, we have completed 5 provincial level consultations on various disaster events and will continue with various tiers of government.

Q: Has there been any solid preparations done yet to channel the resource budget into other relevant GoN ministries as a part of handover? to be reflected in the upcoming new FY budget ? Moreover, it seems to clash with the mandate of NDRRMA to take over NRA's remaining works. Deem necessity of separate capacitated cell formation in NDRRMA to handle NRA's work exclusively is seen through overall discussions. Academic institutions can be prepared for inclusion of donor communities as part of handover preparedness processes. Keeping track of all these preparedness schemes is vital for proper transactions and safe landing.

A: NRA has been quite serious in terms of sustainability issues and has already done a good amount of preparation by documentation of the roster of personnels that involved in NRA's reconstruction and recovery works, from social mobilisers to mobile masons, to engineers and subject experts. Similarly, NRA has made seamless arrangements on the budgetary administration part to insert into upcoming FY's budget line so that the handover process to recipient agencies will be smoothened.

Q: How has NDRRMA been thinking to step up and respond to future mega disaster events by doing things in a different manner?

A: *Municipal and ward level governments have been identified to transfer the local level engagement processes in disaster recovery. Private houses that were damaged by landslides and flood earlier last year in some districts would be reconstructed by accumulating the learnings from NRA where ward governments will be mobilised for identifying beneficiaries.*

Reflecting on the learnings of NRA and moving on with its own broader mandate on multi-hazards events, NDRRMA will engage from provincial to local level to come up with specific DRR plans. Targeted efforts have been channelised to chart out the National Disaster Risk Financing Strategy which is nearing completion soon.

Q: What are upcoming strategies in delivering urban reconstruction and recovery, given that rural reconstruction is more successful than urban? Concerning the transition from NRA to NDRRMA, one suitable option of well equipped preparedness is to transfer the senior management of NRA to similar senior executive management of NDRRMA and take another full 1 year to invest in complete handover of responsibilities. What perceptions are folded by NRA in terms of sorting out involvements of the private sector in livelihood interventions of earthquake affected households?

A: *Inevitably, urban reconstruction took much time with around 50% progress in Kathmandu valley alone. Steering committee chaired by the Prime Minister has been mandated to work on urban renewal schemes. Most probably, the NRA is likely to come up with an urban strategy. However, the NRA is not in a position to address this sector, at least not possible in the timeline of the NRA.*

A conducive environment will be cultivated by NRA's effort even after crossing NRA's period for setting up institutional arrangements on urban renewal. Currently NRA is driven by a clear mandate of phase out by December 2021, therefore no forms of extension has been shaped up mainly to avoid institutional anomaly. NRA is hoping positively for sound transfer to its successor therefore NRA is putting efforts that no stones are unturned in the process of capacity development and knowledge transfer too. Donors and development partners will be given opportunities for their inputs in the process.

Main focus of the NRA was on building resilient infrastructures, therefore livelihood issues received less limelight. NRA is hoping that through World Bank's support, a conducive environment will be nurtured to bring private sectors in livelihood initiatives so that consecutive

transfer to the successor NDRRMA as well as to concerned agencies will be adequately smooth, henceforth to make Nepal a disaster resilient country by 2030.

Q: Time-bound action-plan of the NRA's exit strategy is needed. I understand that this has been worked out. If not, then let this be finalized and shared with the concerned stakeholders including the donors. This would help stakeholders understand the needs for the next nine months and channel their support accordingly.

A: *We have a time-bound exit strategy. We are working out in detail which will be shared in the appropriate time.*

Q: I have a question on the housing completion status. If there is evidence that households haven't started or been able to finish because of land related issues or fall in the vulnerability criteria or ultra-poor - can there be a grievance channel open for this so that the commitment to LNOB is met by end of the year if not continued next year?

A: *In general, the NRA will delist all non-starters. If it is related to vulnerability, the NRA will suggest the local governments to handle. But we will adhere and recognize the NRA's own vulnerability criteria, not beyond.*

Q: What will be the future of all technicians working under NRA after completing its Reconstruction project?

A: *NRA does not take any liability of its employees after its termination. However, the local governments will consider absorbing the trained human resources.*

Q: Shelter provision for around 800,000 quake affected families is one of the major accomplishments of the NRA. It involved multiple aspects: finance, technology, institutional models, community mobilization, land etc. My concern is a need for institutionalization of the overall housing experience through the creation of a national housing development agency or authority. Housing is a human right as per the constitution 2015, Any comments?

A: *This is something the federal government will ponder over. The shelter issue falls under the jurisdiction of the Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD).*

Q: Is there a consideration to handover communication products from NRA to NDRRMA? What will be the communication strategy of the latter?

A: *Sure, all our outputs will be handed over to all of our potential successors including NDRRMA.*

Q: Please share the work frame/strategies how vulnerable listed households and non-

vulnerable private houses who have been halted for a long time at various stages of building construction development will be addressed after the handover process. What if the donor/I/NGOs want to contribute to this sector? What will be the communication strategy of the latter?

A: *Sure, all our outputs will be handed over to all of our potential successors including NDRRMA.*

Q: Management of the Database of Reconstruction is the most important part after the NRA. If we lose the database, we lose achievements. In Nepal, if the projects and programs finish, everything finishes. It should not be like that after the NRA. Capacity development of successors is crucial.

A: *Yes, NRA intends to ensure sustainability, not only of physical assets but also such databases.*

Q: Now we are facing COVID-19's impact. Situation is different from the time of the earthquake. How can stakeholders complete the remaining work of construction?

A: *NRA has been suggesting implementing interventions while maintaining COVID-19 protocols. In the worst case, extension may be required, and our successors will take care of it.*

Q: As you mentioned at the end, donor, and NGO engagement at federal and local level. Why not at province level? Donors and I/NGOs engage with local (and provincial if okay) level, with permission/facilitation of the federal government?

A: *Of course, provinces will be also engaged. However, at present, we have been operating with the federal and local governments which will perpetuate.*

Q: What is the progress of the museum and Earthquake Research Center and where is it located?

A: *The Dharahara and Keshar Mahal museums are under construction. The Earthquake Research Center is at the planning stage.*

Q: How will the current institutions such as CLPIUs, district agencies those working closely with NRA, work with NDRRMA after handing over? Is there any framework developed for the same?

A: *The framework has been evolving.*

Q: Thank you for sharing a very concise and clear road map. You have put some question marks on NDRRMA for the Reconstruction task. I do agree that the present structure, staffing, etc. of NDRRMA needs huge strengthening to carry out reconstruction tasks.

Was your concern about the mandate of NDRRMA as well for this task? Could you please elaborate a bit?

A: *Yes, its formation is overly tilted towards rescue and relief and less towards reconstruction. How to mitigate that lacunae is the concerning factor.*

Q: The engineers in Nepal though familiar to the Indian Codes are not familiar with the National Building Codes though these have been around for quite some years. This could be one of the reasons for damage to the framed structures.

A: *Yes, we see some role of MoUD with this respect.*

Q: On the other hand, retrofitting is a new concept for many practicing engineers and municipal engineers. The exit plan should consider this aspect as well so that a quake of 2015 magnitude in the future would have less effect. These tasks are beyond the scope of NDRRMA and a strong partnership with local universities needs to be developed. This was the approach taken by the European countries for the reconstruction drive following the 2nd World War.

A: *NRA has been working this out in conjunction with the Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC) which will take lead on and may consider engaging the academic institutions as well.*

Q: DoLI needs major capacity building and policy level clarity to handle reconstruction of roads and bridges. It is no longer like it was during the preceding DOLIDAR period. Just handing over the responsibility might not help.

A: *I was referring to the infrastructure which will be handed over to DoLI which I am confident that they will be able to handle. DoLI's overall capacity development is the issue of the Federal Government which they will take care of in due course of time.*

Q: NDRRMA is an apex body for disaster preparedness and response as envisioned in Disaster Management Act. Dr Chandra highlighted that NDRRMA is envisioned for relief and response only. Does this mean there will be a separate entity again for reconstruction where NDRRMA is delegated to deal with all stages of disaster management as I understood in the Disaster Management Act.

A: *The NDRRMA's mandate encompasses all aspects of DRRM (not only response and relief).*

Q: What is the strategy and preparation of NDRRMA for risk reduction & response of possible flood and landslide in the coming monsoon while there is a high possibility that

COVID crisis might last till the monsoon?

A: *We are working on drafting the Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan for this year. It addresses the intersectionality of the COVID crisis with the monsoon disasters namely, floods, landslides, snake bites and water borne diseases.*

Q: Along with the vast experiences and lessons on reconstruction, the NRA has tremendous amounts of data. These data will be extremely useful for researchers and future interventions. How does the NRA and NDRRMA plan to allow these data to be used for research purposes and other future planning/interventions?

A: *The NRA & NDRRMA are working jointly on curating the dataset gathered by NRA. We will make sure that these datasets are available on the NDRRMA's website and make it 'open'.*

Q: Will NDRRMA expand further to undertake this responsibility?

A: *We have started working on restructuring NDRRMA's organizational structure. We have proposed a dedicated division (we are calling it a Directorate) for reconstruction and recovery.*

Q: I'd like to ask for clarification about the NRA -NDRRMA handover plan. For example, social and economic recovery will be handed over to MoFAGA, but will NDRRMA play a coordinating/monitoring role just like the NRA has been doing?

A: *NDRRMA has the mandate to coordinate the social and economic recovery. It will work on coordinating and monitoring roles like that of the NRA.*

Q: What could be the role of coordination to implement different policies and strategies with local governments in future? Is NDRRMA monitoring or coordinating with other development partners who are designing and implementing different training manuals?

A: *This guideline to support the reconstruction of houses damaged by the 2020 floods and landslides is a testimony to how we work with local governments and provincial governments. It has spelled out clear roles for all three levels of governance. We are also mandated to coordinate with development partners, humanitarian agencies, including the private sector.*

Q: Will NDRRMA work like a traditional government organization or will it work out of the box through its business plan?

A: *Reducing risks needs a fast-track approach. Therefore, we are adopting a similar approach followed by the NRA.*

Q: How is NDRRMA planning to incorporate the role that the NRA has played?

A: *As mentioned in my deliberation, we are doing it through four ways: (i) Revising NDRRMA's Act, (ii) Financing modality like NRA's, (iii) Revising its organizational structure and (iv) Coming up with integrated guidelines to address multiple hazards.*

4. VOTE OF THANKS

Dr. **Chandra B. Shrestha** and Mr. **Anil Pokharel** thanked all the participants for active participation. It was expressed that NRA and NDRRMA is committed to work with partners for the sustainability of recovery and reconstruction works and continue to look forward for future collaborations with partners. Mr. Anil further stated that organizational restructuring of NDRMMA will be carried out soon to take over the responsibilities so that NDRRMA comes out as a powerful body to address disaster related reconstruction and recovery through collective approach of partnership and information management.

Minar Thapa from HRRP expressed his sincere gratitude towards Dr. Chandra and Mr. Anil for contributing to this insightful discussion platform. He thanked everyone for their active participation and valuable discussions. He further noted that Nepal's post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction has been remarkable within a short span of time despite the average recovery time period being 12 years irrespective of high or low income countries based on the international experience. He applauded NRA's leadership for these achievements and professional engagement with NDRRMA, line ministries and local governments for a smooth transition plan. He stated that HRRP is committed to extend its coordination and information management services to NDRRMA for successful transition along with addressing longer term needs of NDRRMA aimed at building disaster resilient Nepal and disaster preparedness efforts.

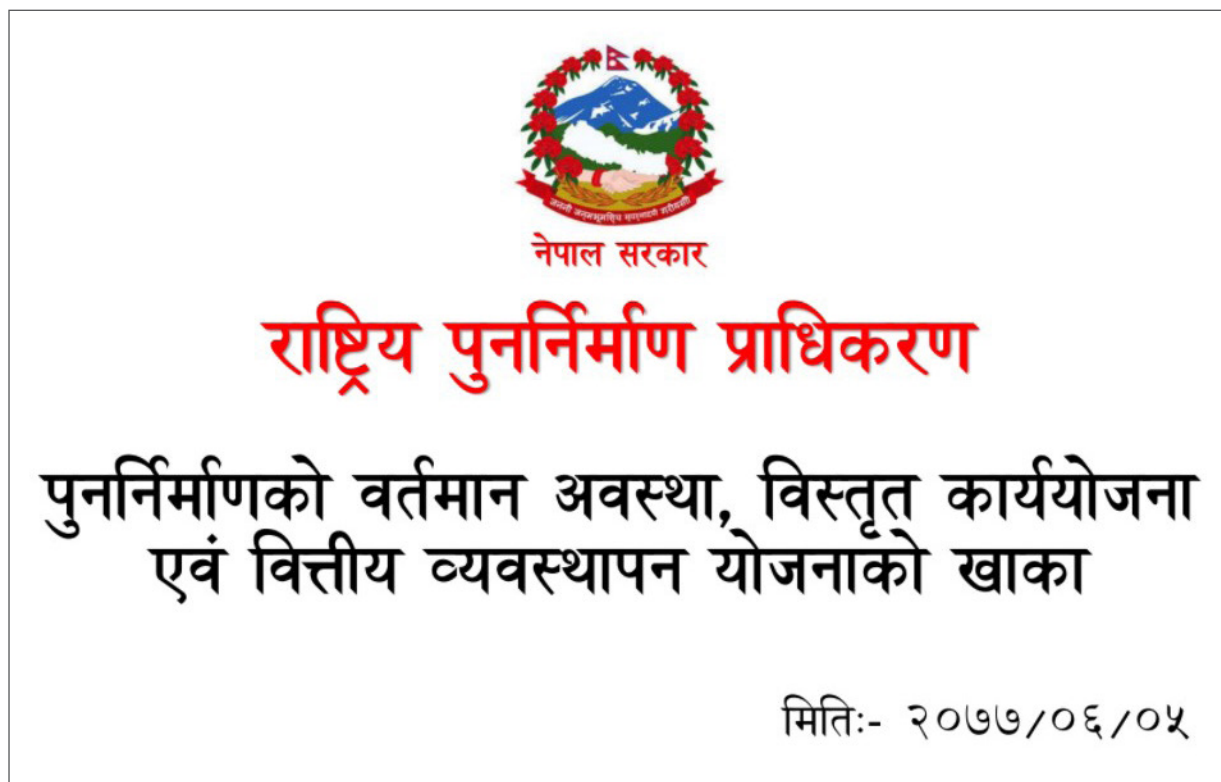
He presented HRRP's vision 2030 for longer-term commitment to ensure safe, dignified homes and communities through transformational change at scale by influencing peer agencies, local responders, stakeholders and governments to implement new, innovative approaches to improve efficiencies in the humanitarian system and urged every humanitarian and development partners for longer-term partnership towards building disaster resilient Nepal.

ANNEX 1

Presentation by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, Executive Committee Member, NRA



[Click here to access the presentation: ENG](#)



[Click here to access the presentation: NEP](#)

ANNEX 2

Participants of the interaction meeting (from ZOOM)

SN	Name	Organization	Country
1	Abigail Ewen	Kings College London (Collaboration with Practical Action Nepal)	UK
2	Aditi Dhakal	National Society for Earthquake Technology	Nepal
3	Ajeet Tiwari	NCRC	Nepal
4	Amanda Duff	FCDO	UK
5	Ambika Amatya	HRRP	Nepal
6	Anand Sapkota	Save the Children	Nepal
7	Anita Niraula		Nepal
8	Anup Dhakal	NDRRMA	Nepal
9	Anup Rana	World Vision	Nepal
10	Apil KC	SONA	Nepal
11	Arati Lamichhane		Nepal
12	Arun Poudel	UNDP CDRMP	Nepal
13	Asano		Japan
14	Asmita Shrestha		Nepal
15	Astha Pradhanang	PIN	Nepal
16	Ayuko Nakamura	JICA	Nepal
17	Ayumi Koyama	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan
18	Badan Nyachhyon	Multi Disciplinary Consultants (P) Ltd.	Nepal
19	Badri Pyakurel	HRRP	Nepal
20	Barsha Shrestha		Nepal
21	Basu Dev Golyan		Nepal
22	Beda Nidhi Khanal	NDRRMA	Nepal
23	Bhesh Raj Thapa	Universal Engineering and Science College	Nepal
24	Bhim Kathayat		Nepal
25	Bhim Raj Basnet	NDRRMA	Nepal
26	Bhubaneswori Parajuli	HRRP	Nepal
27	Bhupendra Basnet	REKV	Nepal
28	Bhupendra Karki		Nepal
29	Bibek Shrestha		Nepal
30	Bidhya Pokhrel	JICA	Nepal
31	Bijay Upadhyay	NSET	Nepal
32	Bikash Panthi	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
33	Bimala Das		Nepal
34	Binaya Acharya	FCA	Nepal
35	Binod Lamichhane	NRCS	Nepal
36	Binod Das Gurung	SVA Nepal	Nepal
37	Bipul Neupane	NRCS	Nepal
38	Bishnu Dawadi	Mott MacDonald	Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
39	Bishnu Kharel	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
40	Bishnu Raj Nepal		Nepal
41	Bishwa P. Aryal		Nepal
42	Bivek Kharel		Nepal
43	Rupesh Yadav	EHRP	Nepal
44	Buddhi Bal Magarati	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
45	Chandra Shrestha	NRA	Nepal
46	Charles Callanan	UNOPS	Nepal
47	Chhan B. Bhattachan	CRS	Nepal
48	Chip Bury	USAID	Nepal
49	Choulaphone Sayasene	CRS	
50	Dan McNamara	PIN	Nepal
51	Danu Darai	HRRP	Nepal
52	David Mann	USAID	Nepal
53	Deepak Saud	HRRP	Nepal
54	Deependra Sharma	UNOPS	Nepal
55	Dev Maharjan		Nepal
56	Dharam Uprety		Nepal
57	Dhruba Paudyal		Nepal
58	Dinanath Bhandari		Nepal
59	Dinesh Bajracharya	NRA	Nepal
60	Dinesh Gurung	DCA	Nepal
61	Dipak Sapkota	NRA	Nepal
62	Ashutosh	NRA	Nepal
63	Dr. Diwat Kumar Shrestha		Nepal
64	Dr. Hare Ram Shrestha		Nepal
65	Dr. Sunit Adhikari	SAPPROS	Nepal
66	Durga Prasad Dhakal	ChildFund Japan	Nepal
67	Durga Sunchiuri	Mennonite Central Committee	Nepal
68	Dwarika Shrestha		Nepal
69	Eak Narayan Dhakal		Nepal
70	Er.Mithlesh Yadav		Nepal
71	Himal Pakhrin		Nepal
72	Ganesh Datt Ojha		Nepal
73	Gaurav Thapa		Nepal
74	Gaurav Panthi	REKV	Nepal
75	Ghanashyam Sapkota	Social Service	Nepal
76	Giri Khatri	Welthunger Hilfe	Nepal
77	Govind Nepal	National Rural Reconstruction	Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
78	Hari Karki	UNFPA	Nepal
79	Haruka Mizobata	JICA	Japan
80	Haruki Ogasa	JICA	Japan
81	Henry Donati	FCDO	UK
82	Hikmat Adhikari	NSET	Nepal
83	Veronique	UNOPS	Nepal
84	Sachin Malego	HRRP	Nepal
85	Ichiro Kobayashi	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan
86	Indra Dev Chaurasiya	Buildup Nepal	Nepal
87	Bandana Sinha		Nepal
88	Ishor Neupane	HRRP	Nepal
89	Ishu Mainali	NRA	Nepal
90	Janak Bhatta	NRA	Nepal
91	Janes Ginting	World Vision	Nepal
92	Jasmine Maharjan	PIN	Nepal
93	Jhapper Singh Vishokarma	CLPIU	Nepal
94	Jini Agrawal	Miyamoto International	Nepal
95	Jitendra Bothara	Resipro	Nepal
96	Judbahadur Gurung	Kadoorie Agricultural Aid Association	Nepal
97	Kailash Shrestha		Nepal
98	Kalpana Aryal	USAID	Nepal
99	Kamala K.C.	FCDO	Nepal
100	Kamran Akbar	World Bank	Nepal
101	Karimi Gitonga	CRS	
102	Kausal Bista	HRRP	Nepal
103	Kedar Dhungana	UNDP	Nepal
104	Keshab Shrestha	HRRP	Nepal
105	Kiran Bhandari		Nepal
106	Kiran Wagle	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
107	Kishore Thapa	Nepal Institute for Urban and Regional Studies(NIURS)	Nepal
108	Katoh Kt	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan
109	Kojika	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan
110	Kosmos		Nepal
111	Krip Raj Joshi		Nepal
112	Krishna Gyawali		Nepal
113	Krishna Kaphle	DAI	Nepal
114	Lajana Manandhar	LUMANTI	Nepal
115	Laxmi Prasad Bhatta	HRRP	Nepal
116	Nagdev Yadav		Nepal
117	Liladhar Adhikari		Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
118	Lokendra Subba	NRA - DLPIU GMaLI	Nepal
119	Lumanti Joshi	LUMANTI	Nepal
120	Maheshwor Adhikari		Nepal
121	Mamta Ojha		Nepal
122	Manish Timsina	NRCS	Nepal
123	Manish	UNOPS	Nepal
124	Manisha Subedi		Nepal
125	Manohar Ghimire	NRA	Nepal
126	Megha Raj Sharma	NRA	Nepal
127	Men Kosal	CRS	
128	Mim Hamal	EC	Nepal
129	Minar Thapa Magar	HRRP	Nepal
130	Miti Patel	HRRP	Nepal
131	Mizanur Rahman	Habitat for Humanity	Bangladesh
132	Mona Sherpa	CARE Nepal	Nepal
133	Moyiz Ebrahimji	UNOPS	Nepal
134	Mr. Anil Pokharel	NDRRMA	Nepal
135	Mrb Ktm		Nepal
136	Nabin Chaudhary		Nepal
137	Nanako Tsukahara	JICA	Japan
138	Naomi Kato	JICA	Nepal
139	Narayan Lamichhane	DCA	Nepal
140	Navraj BC	NRA	Nepal
141	Nilkantha Pandey	CARE Nepal	Nepal
142	Niraj Raut		Nepal
143	Nisha Shrestha	NSET	Nepal
144	Om Rai	BBC Media Action	Nepal
145	Lokendra Thapa		Nepal
146	Prakash Tiwari	World Vision	Nepal
147	Pampha Pariyar		Nepal
148	Phaindra Pandey	CRS	Nepal
149	Pooja Shrestha	VSO Nepal	Nepal
150	Prabhakar Chamling	CRS	Nepal
151	Prabin Gautam	HRRP	Nepal
152	Prafful Maharjan	NRA - DLPIU Building	Nepal
153	Pragya Pradhan	UNDP	Nepal
154	Prajwal Acharya	IFRC	Nepal
155	Prajwol Karki		Nepal
156	Prakash Adhikaree		Nepal
157	Prakash Sanjel	NRA	Nepal
158	Pranav Dahal	NSET	Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
159	Prem Awasthi	UN	Nepal
160	Rabin Malla	Mid Western University	Nepal
161	Radha Verma	FCDO Nepal	Nepal
162	Rahul Pratap Singh	HRRP	Nepal
163	Rajendra Poudel	NDRRMA	Nepal
164	Rajendra Sharma		Nepal
165	Raju Pradhan	Caritas	Nepal
166	Ram Prasad Bhandari		Nepal
167	Ramesh Maharjan	Maya Foundation	Nepal
168	Ramesh Singh		Nepal
169	Ram Krishna Bhetuwal	DLPIU GMaLI	Nepal
170	Ramraj Narasimhan		Nepal
171	Ranjan Dhungel	NSET	Nepal
172	Ratindra Khatri	WFP	Nepal
173	Ratneshwar Lal Karn	Expert Professionals Pvt. Ltd.	Nepal
174	Reshma Shrestha	CRS	Nepal
175	Rijan Gajurel	HRRP	Nepal
176	Rita Thakuri	NSET	Nepal
177	Rohit K. Yadav	VSO Nepal	Nepal
178	Rudra Suwal		Nepal
179	Rupendra Basnet	Habitat for Humanity	Nepal
180	Rupesh Shrestha		Nepal
181	Ruplal Aidi	HRRP	Nepal
182	Sabin Ghimire		Nepal
183	Sabina Bhandari	HRRP	Nepal
184	Sajan Neupane	Mercy Corps	Nepal
185	Samir Subedi		Nepal
186	Sampad Jamarkattel	FCDO	Nepal
187	Sandeep Gurung		Nepal
188	Sanjeeb Shakya	Save the Children	Nepal
189	Sanskar Shrestha		Nepal
190	Santosh Dahal	PLAN International	Nepal
191	Santosh Kulala		Nepal
192	Santosh Kumar Niraula	NRA DLPIU	Nepal
193	Santosh Lama	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
194	Sarita Yadav	Save the Children	Nepal
195	Saroj Kumar Vaidya		Nepal
196	Saujan Shrestha		Nepal
197	Seki Hirano	CRS	Greece
198	Shanta Rana		Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
199	Shanta Rana	UNOPS	Nepal
200	Shaplaneer npoffice	Shaplaneer	Nepal
201	Sher Bahadur Cheetri	World Vision	Nepal
202	Shiva Adhikari	UMN	Nepal
203	Shiva Shrestha	JICA	Nepal
204	Shobhana G. Pradhan	BBC Media Action	Nepal
205	Shrawan Thapa		Nepal
206	Shuva Sharma	Scott Wilson Nepal	Nepal
207	Simon Howarth	Mott MacDonald	Nepal
208	Sita Ram Shrestha		Nepal
209	Sudeep Bahadur Singh	JICA	Nepal
210	Sudin Pradhan	CRS	Nepal
211	Sufi M Faiz	HRRP	Nepal
212	Sulochana Nepali	World Bank	Nepal
213	Suman Bayalkoti	ACN	Nepal
214	Suman Khadka		Nepal
215	Sumit Dugar		Nepal
216	Sunil Poudyal	UNOPS	Nepal
217	Sunil Khadka		Nepal
218	Sunil Sah		Nepal
219	Sunita Shrestha	DLPIU	Nepal
220	Suraj Shrestha	CARE Nepal	Nepal
221	Surendra Bam	CARE Nepal	Nepal
222	Surya Bhakta Sangachhe		Nepal
223	Surya Mohan Dhakal	NRA	Nepal
224	Surya Narayan Shrestha	NSET	Nepal
225	Sushil Dhakal		Nepal
226	Suzuki Koji	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan
227	Sweata Sijapati	HRRP	Nepal
228	Tammie Harris	DAI	Nepal
229	Thakur Prasad Sharma	Full Bright Consultancy Pvt. Ltd.	Nepal
230	Tirtha Raj Joshi	USAID's Tayar Nepal Project	Nepal
231	Bishan Wagle	HRRP	Nepal
232	Udaya B. Thapa	World Vision	Nepal
233	Uddhav Prasad Rijal		Nepal
234	Udhab Subedi	CRS	Nepal
235	Ujjwal Man Shakya	Innovative Creators Pvt. Ltd	Nepal
236	Umesh B. Malla		Nepal
237	Uttam Paudel	CRS	Nepal

SN	Name	Organization	Country
238	Uy Sokchea	CRS	
239	Vera Exnerova	PIN	Nepal
240	Vishma Basnet	HRRP	Nepal
241	Yadav Mainali		Nepal
242	Yubaraj Bhandari	HRRP	Nepal
243	OCG	Oriental Consultants Global	Japan

An Interaction meeting on NRA Disengagement Plan & NDRRMA Engagement Plan

The National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) is scheduled to phase out at the end of 2021 and therefore sustainability of reconstruction efforts is paramount to NRA and the government agencies. In this regard, the NRA is transitioning its responsibilities to other government agencies and primarily to the National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Authority (NDRRMA) as a successor of NRA. Accordingly, NRA's disengagement plan has been prepared for successful transition to NDRRMA and other government agencies including local governments. NDRRMA is also collaborating with NRA and leading its efforts to build disaster resilient communities.

This sharing session aims at understanding what the NRA disengagement plan is and how it is transitioning its work to NDRRMA including other government agencies and local governments. It is in this connection, all development partners, governments including partner organizations who supported Nepal's recovery and reconstruction efforts need to understand the overall disengagement plan of NRA and engagement plan of NDRRMA so that partners can accordingly align their development activities to have synergic effect on the works of local governments and other government agencies.

May 10 2021
START 2 PM NST

Join from ZOOM at

Webinar ID: 928 1017 4503

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Agenda

02:00-02:05	Welcome and introduction of the event (5 min)
02:05-02:25	Presentation by Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha (20 min)
02:25-02:45	Presentation by Mr. Anil Pokharel (20 min)
02:45-03:25	Q & A on the presentations (40 min)
03:25-03:30	Closing (5 min)

Our Speakers

Dr. Chandra B. Shrestha
Executive Committee Member
National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)

Mr. Anil Pokharel
Executive Director
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA)

Facilitated by:

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Organizers and Facilitator:



Government of Nepal
National Reconstruction Authority
Singhadurbar, Kathmandu



Government of Nepal
Home Ministry
National Disaster Risk Reduction and
Management Authority



Housing Recovery and
Reconstruction Platform
Primary Funded by: CRS & UKaid